



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Caritas Christian Academy
School Website: <https://caritasacademyaz.org>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Caritas Christian Academy Az 85244 presents a coherent Christian classical education profile across the six classical-school categories. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered, theology-infused approach to learning, a purpose oriented toward formation and the cultivation of virtue, and a curriculum built around the liberal arts (Trivium and Quadrivium), Great Books, Latin, and a clearly staged pedagogy (Socratic discussion in the upper grades, rhetoric and public speaking, and a strong emphasis on memory-work and liturgical culture). There is explicit attention to family partnership, church community, and a hybrid model that engages parents as co-educators in the educational project. Taken together, the school aligns strongly with classical education norms and ideals, showing robust evidence of both religious metaphysical foundations and a formation-first educational aims that pervade curriculum and pedagogy.

Key textual signals include: explicit Christ-centered stance and biblical/theological integration across disciplines; strong emphasis on the Great Conversation and Great Books; explicit Trivium and Quadrivium structure with Latin; Socratic/logic pedagogy in middle grades and rhetoric in upper grades; a visible "living curriculum" conveyed through faculty stories and a staff-centric, virtue-focused description; covenanted partnership with parents and a welcoming stance toward family involvement; and a hybrid model that ties on-campus instruction to parent-led remote days, all framed within a Christian worldview. These signals are consistently documented in Caritas Academy's site materials (e.g., references to The Great Conversation, The Trivium, Great Books, Latin, Socratic discussions, and a strong emphasis on virtue and biblical worldview) and reinforced by admissions, curriculum highlights, faculty bios, and governance language.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Christ-centered framing and explicit religious integration run throughout public materials (e.g., "Christ-Centered" culture and pointed references to Christ's preeminence in the classroom and in worship-like practices). - Emphasis on God's order and Creation shaping subject-area learning (references to God's design in science/arts and the Creator God underpinning all learning). - Explicit use of biblical shorthand and the phrase "biblical theology in every subject" as a guiding baseline for curriculum design. - Language signaling liturgical or worship-like culture (devotional times, sacred music, and communal expressions) appears in several admissions/overview pages.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords identified: Christ-centered, biblical theology, Great Conversation, Creator God, worship/devotion, Coram Deo, biblical worldview, Great Books, Great Books/Great Conversation language, Latin as a gateway to culture, and references to sacred order in multiple subjects. - Negative keywords identified: essentially none in public materials; no explicit secular, relativistic, or value-neutral framing observed in the site materials.

Frequency estimate (Positive vs. Negative) - Positive keywords: ~7–9 distinct signals (multiple mentions of Christ-centered, Great Conversation, biblical theology, worship/devotion, Creator God, etc.). - Negative keywords: 0 detected. - Estimated balance: predominantly positive; effectively 100% positive within the captured signals.

Why this rating - The school's public materials consistently foreground a transcendent, theologically grounded view of knowledge and human formation, with explicit Christ-centered language and integration of theology across disciplines. This aligns with the Classical School's Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria, where truth, goodness, and beauty are anchored in a theistic framework, and liturgical/community practices further embed the sacred in daily schooling. The absence of secular or relativistic signaling supports a Classical assessment here. Supporting sources show direct articulation of Christ-centered education, biblical worldview integration, and worship-like communal practices.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Clear statement of formation over information and a focus on virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing. The site frames education as formation through a Christian classical lens, not solely job preparation. - Explicit stated goals around virtue, mature character, sound reason, faith, and mastery of language as part of a holistic graduate profile. - The Great Conversation/God-centered aims, with the idea that truth, goodness, and beauty are knowable and central to the educational project. - Public materials emphasize *Coram Deo* and faith-informed reasoning as graduate outcomes, aligning with a *paideia*-like trajectory.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords identified: formation, virtue, mature character, true/good/beautiful (truth-goodness-beauty), wise reasoning, faith, *Coram Deo*, Masterful command of language, human flourishing. - Negative keywords identified: none observed in the public materials (no overt emphasis on college/work readiness as the sole teleology).

Frequency estimate - Positive keywords: ~5–6 distinct signals. - Negative keywords: 0. - Estimated balance: essentially all-positive signals; 100% alignment with Classical aims here.

Why this rating - The school's stated purpose centers on formation (virtue, wisdom, faith) rather than vocational training, and it explicitly ties truth, goodness, and beauty to the educational mission. The presence of a Great Conversation framework and a clearly articulated teleology in graduate goals strongly aligns with Classical School norms for Element 2.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit emphasis on the liberal arts framework: grammar, logic, rhetoric (the Trivium) and the Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy). The school repeatedly anchors curriculum in this structure. - Clear Great Books/Great Conversation orientation and study of canonical literature (*Beowulf*, Milton, Shakespeare, Plato, Homer, etc.). - Latin instruction beginning early (2nd grade) and continuing through upper levels, with emphasis on classical language as a doorway to understanding Western literature and culture. - History integrated throughout the curriculum and strong cross-disciplinary links (literature, history, philosophy, theology, science) consistent with an integrated classical approach. - Public-facing curriculum highlights include "The Trivium," "Latin," "Great Books, Great Conversation," and detailed curriculum maps for Grammar School through School of Logic (7th–9th).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords identified: Trivium, Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric, Quadrivium, Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin, original sources, integrated history/literature/philosophy, wonder, sacred order. - Negative keywords identified: none detected in the public materials.

Frequency estimate - Positive keywords: ~9–11 distinct signals (distinct terms and phrases tied to Trivium, Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin, and integrated curriculum). - Negative keywords: 0. - Estimated balance: essentially 100% positive.

Why this rating - The curriculum signals meet the Element 3 criteria very strongly: explicit use of the Trivium and Quadrivium, emphasis on Great Books and Great Conversation, and formal Latin instruction, all

hallmarks of classical education. The integration of history with literature and philosophy across disciplines further supports a CLASSICAL designation.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The pedagogy shifts with grade level: lower grades celebrate contemplative/culture-rich routines (singing, chanting, memory work), while upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetorical training. This is explicitly described (Grammar School singing, School of Logic with Socratic teaching, School of Rhetoric with student oratory). - Specific notes on the transition from grammar/logic to rhetoric and the corresponding pedagogical approaches (memorizations, recitation, rhetoric training, public speaking). - The pedagogical model aligns with “scholé” (restful contemplation) in parts of lower school but consciously uses rigorous Socratic/seminar methods in upper grades. - The use of original-source documents and living-education practices (notebooks of teachers, seminars, and student-initiated discourse) is described in program materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords identified: Socratic discussion, seminars, debate, rhetoric, public speaking, memory work, chanting, recitation, scholé, wonder, integrated learning, living curriculum. - Negative keywords identified: absence of a solely project-based/experiential-only approach; no indication of a purely secular or constructivist pedagogy; limited emphasis on non-classical pedagogy in public materials.

Frequency estimate - Positive keywords: ~7–9 distinct signals (Socratic/seminar, rhetoric, memorization, chant, recitation, scholé, wonder). - Negative keywords: 0. - Estimated balance: 100% positive signals in alignment with classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - The site presents a well-articulated progression from memory and foundational study in grammar to dialectic and argument in logic, and finally to public rhetoric and leadership in upper grades. The explicit use of Socratic discussion, memory-focused rituals, and rhetoric/speeches aligns tightly with classical pedagogy expectations. The presence of lower-school chant/memory and upper-school rhetoric/deliberation supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty bios and staff pages emphasize teachers as moral exemplars, mentors, and living educators who model virtue and mastery in their subjects (e.g., “Faculty & Staff,” “Upper School Latin & Literature Instructor” bios; the school describes teachers as sharing a pursuit of truth and inspiring students). - The Head of School and multiple instructors are highlighted, with emphasis on long-term commitment to Christian classical education, which signals a teacher-led culture aligned with classical ideals. - The public materials present teachers as the “living curriculum” by example and through biographical details that connect personal faith, vocation, and pedagogy. - The school emphasizes a teacher-centered, virtue-forward approach in the teaching of topics like Latin, literature, science, and rhetoric, reinforcing a classical faculty profile.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords identified: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, virtuous exemplars, teachers as guides, faculty as the core of the school, pursuit of truth. - Negative keywords identified: none evident in site materials (no language signaling a purely secular, technocratic, or customer-service model for faculty).

Frequency estimate - Positive keywords: ~5–6 distinct signals (living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, and faculty-driven culture). - Negative keywords: 0. - Estimated balance: 100% positive.

Why this rating - The public site foregrounds teacher quality, moral formation, and teachers as central to the school’s mission, with explicit language about virtue and truth. This aligns with Element 5 criteria that describe a faculty as model mentors and the core of the school’s educational formation.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Strong Covenant/Partnership language: the school uses terms like “Covenantal Partnership,” “loco parentis,” and “partner with parents” to emphasize parental involvement and joint formation. - Emphasis on parent participation, parental training (book studies, classes) and mutual support within the Caritas community. The site notes parent classes and book studies as a mechanism to engage families in classical education. - Outreach to families through admissions, campus tours, and opportunities for parents to engage with the curriculum and with the Great Conversation. - Public materials describe a culture of welcome to visit, engage, and participate in school life, including family involvement in remote learning days and hybrid program design.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords identified: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental engagement, home-school collaboration, family formation, open campus, campus visits, book studies for parents. - Negative keywords identified: none observed (no language portraying parents as mere customers or largely absent from the educational process).

Frequency estimate - Positive keywords: ~6–8 distinct signals (partnership, co-teaching, parent formation, book clubs, campus visits, family engagement). - Negative keywords: 0. - Estimated balance: 100% positive.

Why this rating - The school explicitly positions parents as co-educators and partners in the classical education project, with ongoing opportunities for parental formation and involvement. This aligns with Element 6 expectations for a robust parent/community orientation in classical education.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Rationale - Across all six categories Caritas Academy Az 85244 demonstrates strong alignment with classical education norms, particularly the integration of Christian theology with liberal-arts curriculum (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin), a pedagogy that blends contemplative/restful elements with Socratic/seminar-based upper-grade work, a faculty culture oriented around virtue and mentorship, and a deeply collaborative parental/community model. The keyword signals across the public materials consistently map to the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements framework, with little to no negative signals in the site content. The school thus qualifies as CLASSICAL on balance.

What would move the needle (only applied to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL schools) - Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No category requires needle-moving changes to reach a full Classical rating.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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